A-A-54445
15 July 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

# PASTE, PERIODONTAL PROTECTIVE, SURGICAL (Soft Dressing)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-P-37920(DM), which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers a soft, protective, periodontal paste suitable for use in covering and protecting the surface of surgical wounds.

Salient characteristics:

The periodontal protective paste shall consist of a base, an accelerator, and a retarder. The base and the accelerator shall be pastes and the retarder shall be a liquid. When the pastes are mixed in accordance with manufacturer's instructions, they shall form a mass with a soft plastic consistency which adapts easily to teeth and tissue. The mixture shall resist dislodgement by the movement which is associated with eating and speaking and shall be easy to apply to and easy to remove from a wound. The use of a retarder shall increase the working time and shall not change the other characteristics of the mixture. No component shall contain eugenol, asbestos, or cotton fibers.

Materials. Materials shall be of the highest quality throughout and shall be suitable in all respects for the purpose intended. Where applicable, material shall be in accordance with the requirements of the latest edition of the United States Pharmacopeia (USP) or the National Formulary (NF). Any material used in the periodontal paste which is not included in the USP or NF shall be of a quality suitable for dental use.

Base. The base shall consist of the following ingredients: rosin, ethyl cellulose, natural gums and wax, fatty acid, chlorothymol, spearmint oil, zinc acetate, alcohol, purified water, lanolin, and petroleum jelly.

Accelerator. The accelerator shall consist of the following ingredients: zinc oxide, vegetable oil, chlorothymol, colloidal silicon dioxide (optional), magnesium oxide, coumarin, parachlorometaxylenol, red dye, and mineral oil.

Retarder. The retarder shall consist of triethanolamine or glycerine.

AMSC N/A FSC 6520

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Color. The base and accelerator shall be distinctly different in color. The mixture of base and accelerator shall be pink.

Performance. When tested as specified below, mixing time shall be 45 seconds ± 15 seconds. When no retarder is used, peel time shall be 3 minutes ± 1 minute and final set time shall be 15 minutes ± 5 minutes, when tested as specified below. Working time is final set time minus peel time. Working time shall be a minimum of 6 minutes when no retarder is used. Working time shall be a minimum of 15 minutes when a retarder is used.

Immediate container. Base and accelerator pastes shall be in suitable metal, collapsible tubes with round opening and screw cap closure. The retarder shall be in a glass or plastic bottle with screw cap closure.

Capacity. Net weight of accelerator shall be at least 90 grams; net weight of base shall be at least 90 grams; and net weight of retarder shall be at least 4 grams. Volume after mixing a tube of accelerator with a tube of base shall be at least 125 milliliters.

Marking. The tube of accelerator paste shall be marked "ACCELERATOR" or "1", and the tube of base paste shall be marked "BASE" or "2", and the bottle of retarder shall be marked "RETARDER". The lot number and date of manufacture shall be marked on all containers.

ADA Acceptance. The contractor shall furnish proof that the offered periodontal paste has been accepted by the Council on Dental Materials and Devices and the Council on Dental Therapeutics of the American Dental Association (ADA). Compliance with these acceptance requirements does not absolve the contractor from complete compliance with the requirements of this specification.

Instructions. Adequate and accurate instructions for proportioning and manipulating pastes shall accompany each unit package. Instructions shall contain information about the extension of working time by use of the retarder.

Workmanship. All components and immediate containers shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one tube of base paste, one tube of accelerator paste, and one bottle of retarder, and instructions for use constitutes one unit.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after the delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more inspection characteristics. The unit of product for inspection purposes shall be one package of periodontal paste. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be conducted at inspection level II, AQL 2.5, and sampling for tests (when applicable) shall be conducted at inspection level S-1, AQL 1.0.

Examination. The periodontal paste shall be examined to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

Weight and volume. Net weight of base and accelerator pastes in tubes and net weight of retarder in bottle shall be measured with a suitable balance. Volume after mixing a tube of base paste with a tube of accelerator paste shall be measured by a suitable method.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Reaction time. Accelerator and base shall be mixed in accordance with package instructions. Mixing shall be considered complete when mixture is a homogeneous pink color. The elapsed time is mixing time. Mixture shall be placed on nonabsorbent parchment paper and shall be left on paper until it can be removed without sticking. After removal from the paper, ropes shall be formed from the mixture. Peel time is the period of time from the beginning of the mixing to the time when mixture can be removed from the paper without sticking. Final set time is the period of time from the beginning of the mixing to the time when 3 or 4 millimeter diameter ropes break. Working time is the difference between final set time and peel time.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

| National Stock Number | Item Identification |
|---|---|
| 6520-01-047-3577 | PASTE, PERIODONTAL PROTECTIVE, Surgical, Soft Dressing |

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be as specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6520-2473
Location: PL #1/paste



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

# STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

## INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

| I RECOMMEND A CHANGE: | 1. DOCUMENT NUMBER: A-A-54445 | 2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD): 15 July 1991 |
|---|---|---|

3. DOCUMENT TITLE: PASTE, PERIODONTAL PROTECTIVE, SURGICAL (Soft Dressing)

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

| a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial) | b. ORGANIZATION |
|---|---|
| c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) | d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable) / e. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD) |

7. PREPARING ACTIVITY

| a. NAME | b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial / (2) AUTOVON |
|---|---|
| Defense Personnel Support Center | (215)737-2870 / 444-2870 |
| c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) ATTN: DPSC-MSE, 2800 S. 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101 | IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office, 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466, Telephone (703) 756-2340, AUTOVON 289-2340 |

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 — Previous editions are obsolete

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.